

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Cat Toy Pattern for Beginners

A tiny stuffed mouse using the same amigurumi shaping as our mini ball pattern, with an optional catnip fill.

Updated 2026 • US terms • About 3in / 7.5cm long



This little mouse toy uses the same increase-and-decrease shaping from our [mini amigurumi ball pattern](#), with a simple tail and ears added on. It's a quick evening project, and a genuinely useful one if you have a cat that loves to bat things around.

Pet safety note: use plain, safe yarn without loose fibres or embellishments, stitch tightly, and check the toy periodically for wear. Discard and replace if seams start to loosen. See the FAQ below for more detail.

MATERIALS

- Small amount of worsted-weight yarn (under 20 yards)
- 3.5mm hook (smaller than standard, for tight amigurumi stitches)
- A pinch of polyester fiberfill stuffing, optionally mixed with a small amount of catnip
- Stitch marker, to track the start of each round
- Scissors

- Yarn needle, for closing and weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.	MEANS
ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in same stitch (increase)
dec	Sc 2 sts together (decrease)
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.



Reference book and notions for finishing a small crochet toy

GAUGE

Gauge isn't critical for this small project — the goal is tight, even stitches that hide the stuffing rather than an exact measurement. If you can see stuffing

through your stitches, try a smaller hook.

NOTES

- Written in US terms and worked in a continuous spiral, same technique as our [mini amigurumi ball pattern](#).
- Use a smaller hook than you'd normally pair with this yarn weight to keep stuffing (and catnip) from showing through.
- Mix a pinch of catnip into the stuffing if desired, rather than leaving it loose, and stitch the closing seam securely.

Pattern

BODY, ROUND 1

Make a magic ring, 6 sc into ring, place marker. (6 sts)

BODY, ROUND 2

Inc in every st around. (12 sts)

BODY, ROUND 3

[sc 1, inc] around. (18 sts)

BODY, ROUNDS 4–7

Sc in every st around, no increases or decreases. (18 sts each round)

BODY, ROUND 8

[sc 1, dec] around. (12 sts)

Begin adding stuffing now, mixed with catnip if using, before the opening gets too small.

BODY, ROUND 9

Dec in every st around. (6 sts)

Add a bit more stuffing to fill evenly.

EARS (MAKE 2)

Make a magic ring, 5 sc into ring. Fasten off, leaving a short tail for sewing on.

TAIL

Chain 12. Fasten off, leaving both ends free for sewing.

FINISHING

Close the body opening by threading the tail through the front loops of the last round and pulling tight. Sew the two ears onto the top of the body, and sew one end of the chain tail onto the back. Weave in all ends securely, going through several stitches rather than just a knot before trimming.

Frequently asked questions

Is it safe to put catnip inside a handmade crochet toy?

Yes, as long as the toy is stitched tightly and securely closed. Mix a small amount of loose or crushed catnip in with the stuffing rather than leaving it loose, and check the seams periodically for wear.

What yarn is safest for a cat toy?

A plain worsted-weight cotton or acrylic yarn without loose fibres, sequins, or novelty textures is safest, since pets can chew and potentially swallow loose bits.

How do I make sure the toy stays closed if my cat plays rough?

Use a smaller hook than the yarn label suggests for tighter stitches, and weave the closing tail through several stitches before trimming rather than a simple knot, which can work loose over time.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.